

Section 1: Short Answer Questions (20%)**1. Realism in Donnelly: "According to Jack Donnelly's discussion of Realism, how does Kenneth Waltz's structural realism differ from classical realism?"**

The differences between classical realism and structural realism firstly appear on definition of Realism in textbooks, where author with 'and' or 'or' used 'egoism' beside 'anarchy'. Although both classical and structural realism emphasize power and security, the original reason that has led to doing so is different. Classical realism believes human nature is selfish based on Hobbes' philosophy. In the absence of government at an international level that can control leaders' appetites for more creates a condition of violent conflict. Indeed, the main part of state behavior is internal and related to human nature that Hobbes asserts it is not changeable. After the entry of positivism into the field of international relations and criticisms on the non-scientific nature of the arguments used, Kenneth Waltz tried to structure realism. He replaced the unit of analysis from human nature of leaders to state in international level. In contrast to domestic politics in which there is hierarchical system, at an international level a horizontal relationship exists between states because there is no leader in this level thereby international order is anarchy. The behavior of states is also identical. The only structural variable that can remain determinant is 'the distribution of capabilities.' Therefore, what has fundamentally shaped the behavior of state in the international system is anarchy as an external factor not leaders' motivation as an internal factor based on human nature.

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Brown, C., & Ainsley, K. (2005). *Understanding International Relations, Third Edition*. Palgrave Macmillan. <https://books.google.com.cy/books?id=hP9CvgAACAAJ>

Burchill, S., Paterson, M., Reus-Smit, C., Linklater, A., Devetak, R., True, J., & Donnelly, J. (2005). *Theories of International Relations, Third Edition*. Palgrave Macmillan. <https://books.google.com.cy/books?id=QzGhAQAACAAJ>

Griffiths, M. (2007). *International Relations Theory for the Twenty-First Century: An Introduction*. Taylor & Francis. https://books.google.com.cy/books?id=TKZ_AgAAQBAJ

2. Liberal Internationalism: "What are the core tenets of Liberal Internationalism post-Cold War, as outlined by Burchill?"

in the 1990s Fukuyama help to fostering long belief among liberalist in which expanding domestic legitimate principles of a democratic society to international order where states have relationship with each other can end the conflicts. Indeed, peace, trade, international institutions, interdependency and human rights are key principles of liberal internationalism. Peace is natural and war is antinatural and irrational based on Kant's perspective. Democratic peace theory shows that democratic states have no tendency to resolve their problem with one another by war. Therefore, they make a zone of peace. Increasing liberal-democrat state across the world can expand the zone of peace. But the problem of conflict between democratic state and non-democratic state has remained. There is a contradictory between the spirit of trade and war. Thus,

free trade can make economic self-interest based on theory of comparative advantage in order to restrain conflict. Interdependence like cooperation and integration in the European Union demonstrates that the possibility of conflict decreases because of common interest. International institutions play a crucial role in this vision by encouraging cooperation, monitoring compliance, adjusting rules, and making sanctions. It can happen in an anarchical world. Human rights and relevant institutions are the other principles that encourage states to comply with human freedom. A state that has appropriate with its citizen is less aggressive in its international behavior. Meanwhile, Marxists argue that liberal human rights couldn't address exploitive nation of capitalism. Human intervention is the other debate in this field. In sum, an 'inside-out' approach has been pursued by Liberal Internationalism.

Reference:

Burchill, S., Paterson, M., Reus-Smit, C., Linklater, A., Devetak, R., True, J., & Donnelly, J. (2005). *Theories of International Relations, Third Edition*. Palgrave Macmillan.
<https://books.google.com.cy/books?id=QzGhAQAAAJ>

3. Critical Theory by Linklater: "What role does the 'politics of knowledge' play in shaping IR according to Linklater?"

The positivism pursued by traditional theories is an approach in which by utilizing scientific methods and quantitative manners to find out social laws and to predict behavior of human. The issue is that positivism creates some knowledge to increase administration efficiency of society. Due to the lack of ethical dimension in Positivism, the reasons why goals should be achieved are not explained but just it can explain how can achieve ends. What Weber called iron cage is rooted

in “value-neutral” knowledge led to prioritize efficiency over humanity. When reason becomes instrumental (rationality), the potential of emancipation and creative thought are lost. Indeed, knowledge produced in positivism serves to those who are community administrators with specific political approach. It is so far from enlightenment ideals including emancipation and increasing human freedom. Knowledge becomes to instrumental reason to control society and suppression. Horkheimer argued that science could provide means to an end, it could not dictate moral values or purposes; it could explain what is but not what ought to be. Knowledge can reduce to means to perpetuate political and social control and to justify domination. As Cox's Perspective, theories support certain interests over others, emphasizing that knowledge is inherently political.

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Burchill, S., Paterson, M., Reus-Smit, C., Linklater, A., Devetak, R., True, J., & Donnelly, J. (2005). *Theories of International Relations, Third Edition*. Palgrave Macmillan.
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4. Constructivism in Reus-Smit: "According to Reus-Smit, how does anarchy differ based on social interactions and shared norms? Provide a quote from the assigned readings to support your answer."

“Anarchy is what States Make of it” Alexander Wendt. To answer this question, I will also use Alexander Wendt’s article. Realism defines anarchy by helping Hobbes. In this definition states consider each other as threats based on enmity and power politics. Kenneth Waltz argues that

anarchy is a self-help system. Liberalism claims that anarchy is characterized by rivalry. States can see one another as competitors. Kant gives a friendship character to anarchy. Therefore, there is a chance of cooperation. The key point is that concepts have been shaped socially by norms and identities. They are not merely atomistic rational beings. Wendt said: "if society "forgets" what a university is, the powers and practices of professor and student cease to exist; if the United States and Soviet Union decide that they are no longer enemies, "the cold war is over. It is collective meanings that constitute the structures which organize our actions." As a result, because anarchy is socially constructed, the behavior of states and the nature of the international system can evolve over time through shifts in norms and identities.

Reference:

Burchill, S., Paterson, M., Reus-Smit, C., Linklater, A., Devetak, R., True, J., & Donnelly, J. (2005). *Theories of International Relations, Third Edition*. Palgrave Macmillan.
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Wendt, A. (1992). Anarchy is what states make of it: the social construction of power politics. *International Organization*, 46(2), 391–425.

Section 2: Analytical Essays (50%)

Choose one of the following essay topics (5-6 Pages).

"Compare how Marxism and Critical Theory approach global capitalism. Include arguments from Griffiths and discuss the influence of global capitalism."

Historical Materialism is the proper basis to trace the evolution of global system from the beginning when humans started to create social system in order to organize how they produce and reproduce their material needs until now that we face a sophisticated international capital system of produce. Over time, both the material world and humans themselves have been changed by the process of production. As Marx said, human beings create “their own history.” In this process of building has been limited by the legacy of the ideas and social systems of our ancestors. Liberal capitalism is one of them that is successor of previous systems like feudalism and mercantilism. The crucial difference between capitalism and the formers lies in dichotomic concept of freedom within it. To make capital it needs a free worker. One can sell only her/his own goods which are labor power. The owners of the means of production retain control of the system and obtain profit from production. Therefore, class power relations have been shaped. Market shows itself an independent unit from the influence of people, thereby an alienation appears among people from each other and their own work. It is a liberal offer of naturalized and privatized economics apart from the formally political area of the state. Fordism is an example of organization of labor power that has extended to a global level.

Antonio Gramsci has a crucial role to more comprehensive understanding about the process of capitalism by concept of hegemony. Capital societies maintain their power by combination of coercion and consent. It can hold dominant social orders. Gramsci was not sure what Marx considered an economic change toward social transformation by mechanical or economic interpretations. It should be mentioned as criticism of Marx who had a deterministic view in which socialism is the automatic synthesis of status quo. He emphasized the decisive role of social agents. The consciousness of humans can distinguish consent built by ideology. For instead, as professor Erol explained, a high-ranking employee cannot feel that she/he is in the same class with sweepers,

and both are selling their work to the owner of capital. Indeed, the political system is embedded in a global system of production with complex relations between economic, political, and cultural forces.

Dependency theory can explain unequal relations between states in the international system of capital. It is based on Marxism and has tried to account for the Global South's dependence on the dominant great powers. The capitalist world economy has been shaped into a division of labor, thereby a dominant core and a subordinate periphery are two sides of this relationship. The periphery prepares raw material and cheap labor, and imports finished goods from the core states. Accumulation of capital in the core side causes continual inequality between them. In effect, the hierarchical order has been dominated on world order to exploit weakness states.

Globalization is a part of capitalism process in which national economies are subsumed in global circuits of capital. Emerging a transnational capitalist class is the outcome of this process. Nation-state has transformed to multilayered transnational state that the global capitalist system can use it as its own political body. Indeed, economic and political institutions and elites are necessary to maintain global hegemony. International and transnational power relations (like how states interact or how global power structures work) are embedded in social systems of production. In other words, how societies produce goods and organize labor (which involves class relations, and in modern times, race and gender) influences global politics.

The roots of critical theory lie in Marxism. The thinkers of this point of view follow Marx's critical vision of capitalist society. But their criticism is based on the deterministic interpretation in which Marxism considers the systemic mechanisms of change to be merely material. That is, material economic conditions guide social changes. This approach ignores the complexities of modern society and the liberating potential of man. Habermas' effort as one of the pioneers of critical theory

is to expand Marx's theory of historical materialism to deal with the complexities of the current world society. Habermas' theory of communicative action can be considered as an attempt to avoid the positivist and deterministic interpretations of Marxism. This theory emphasizes the importance of dialogue, mutual understanding and rational discourse as basic tools that contribute to social change. Therefore, the approach of Marxism and critical theory towards capitalism has convergence, but the latter tries to keep its distance from positivism more.

The main goal of critical theory is emancipation of humans. Critical theory thinkers believe in inequality and dominance in global power relations. Capitalist societies, contrary to the values they promote, such as equality and freedom, have a significant conflict with human ideals. What helps capitalism survive is the use of positivism. Indeed, Positivism is an instrument of control through which the owner of power by using knowledge controls society. When reason becomes instrumental (rationality), the potential of emancipation and creative thought are lost. The result of justifying the existing and unchanging order is to show it. Critical theory criticizes this naturalization of the existing political and economic system. Their focus is on the moral deficiencies in the way the state interacts with the global capitalist economy.

Andrew Linklater's *Men and Citizens* tracks how modern political thought has consistently differentiated ethical obligations between co-citizens and the rest of humanity. He scours to recover a political philosophy based on universal ethical reasoning, which has been marginalized in the twentieth century, particularly with the onset of the Cold War and the hegemony of realism. Cox and his associate Stephen Gill have analyzed the transformation of global order instigated by globalization, emphasizing the internationalization of state functions and the emergence of a neo-liberal business culture. This phenomenon has resulted in the prioritization of market-driven imperatives over the social objectives of the state, thereby disassociating the economy from

societal contexts and engendering a multifaceted global order characterized by escalating tensions between territorial sovereignty and interdependence. The ramifications of this economic globalization encompass a widening divide between affluent and impoverished populations, as well as the rise of exclusionary populist movements. Critical theorists challenge the assertions of positivism by positing that ideals are not beyond comprehension; rather, they are intricately woven into social frameworks and communicative practices. Through the method of immanent critique, which reveals contradictions and anchors ideals in the fundamental norms of discourse, critical theorists contend that it is feasible to identify the ideals that humanity ought to advocate. This perspective stands in stark opposition to positivism, illustrating that ideals arise from social, historical, and communicative contexts, existing not as immutable or abstract notions but as concrete components of human interaction and societal structures.

Marxism and critical theory both see capitalism as the main cause of social inequality, oppression and exploitation of society by the owners of power and capital. This situation prevails at the global level as well, in the relations between richer states and underdeveloped states and in the transnational economy where multinational companies control the market. The main difference is in the solutions to face this problem. Marxism focuses on economics and material change, although neo-Gramscian have tried to go beyond Marx's ideas. On the other hand, critical thinking speaks to the role of individuals to bring about change.

Marxism, at least in its classical version, was a practical theory aimed at the struggle against exploitation. It rooted in massive differences of classes to access wealth so that the bourgeoisie had the power, and the proletariat had no share of it. Therefore, the solution relied on the working class prevailed over capitalism. The result in practice was disaster. Exploitation didn't disappear but appeared in another form. Soviet Union is an example. Who can claim that China is a true

example of communist state when the evidence of capitalism is visible in its face. The situation of Cuba that is suffering from lack of electricity these days demonstrates the big gap between idealist aim and existing truth. Vietnam is a part of chain of world production while it has retained Marxism as its political system. The main problem is that the role of the individual has been forgotten. Critical theory can give a world view to see power relations and find where knowledge bears the point of view of its owners. It also is helpful to criticize neorealism and neoliberalism in the real world and to show their consequences. Individuals are important in this approach, through which hope to make change led to deep perception from world system that is not unchangeable. On the other hand, instead of traditional theories like realism or liberalism even Marxism, critical theory does not have a broad comprehensive practical instruction, thereby issues remain unresolved. Finally, I believe that critical theory has extended our view to IR, especially capitalist order and it is important that consider different functions of critical theory in comparison with main theories.

References:

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Section 3: Simulation Exercise (20%)

Scenario: Analyze a territorial dispute using one IR theory; describe motivations, actions, outcomes. Include relevant quotes from assigned readings to support your analysis.

- Expected Outcome: A 2–3-page analysis applying chosen theory to crisis.

The South China Sea dispute

To answer this question, the first step is to identify the motivations of the parties to the dispute. Do they have economic or security benefits? Does that territory have cultural or ideological value for them? Then the actions of the parties must be identified. Finally, short-term, and long-term consequences should be identified. This essay will use liberalism that emphasizes economic interdependence, shared norms, the role of institutions, and international cooperation, as the theory of choice.

The South China Sea dispute has several involved parties such as China, Philippines, Vietnam, Malaysia etc. The parties have security concerns and territorial claims over islands and sea areas and resources such as fisheries and oil and gas. China regards the South China Sea as its sovereign territory, necessitating prior authorization for any entry. This stance is deemed unacceptable by other interested countries.

The South China Sea is one of the most important economic routes in world trade. It is normal for the states in the region to have more control over the mentioned resources and economic profit. Liberalism is a distinct framework within International Relations Theory, incorporating a range of concepts and arguments regarding the capacity of institutions, behaviors, and economic ties to

restrain and alleviate conflict. The liberal world order is defined by some interconnected elements: the presence of international law and treaties is complemented by international organizations, the proliferation of free trade and capital in the world, international norms that promote cooperation, and the rule of law.

From the point of view of liberalism, the mutual benefits of peaceful cooperation include all countries in the region. ASEAN countries support the UN Convention on the Law of the Sea. It shows that common institutions and norms are the appropriate solution provided in liberalism paradigm to prevent the formation and escalation of tensions. The establishment of a joint supervisory body between the parties to the dispute and the presence of neutral international observers for the transparent implementation of the agreements between them is a liberal way.

Liberalism bases the actions of the states involved in the South China Sea dispute on multilateral agreements and focusing on diplomacy. In the meantime, ASEAN has played a significant role in establishing dialogue between the parties and resolving disputes through negotiation. An example of that is the China-ASEAN Declaration in 2002 on how the parties to the conflict should behave with the aim of peaceful management. It called upon the parties involved to demonstrate restraint to foster a constructive environment conducive to the eventual resolution of all disputes. The Permanent Court of Arbitration ruled that China's territorial claims were invalid in 2016. International law and international institutions such as the Permanent Court of Arbitration are examples of liberalism in the world. Of course, China did not accept the ruling. But adherence of other countries to the result of the court shows the importance of common norms in liberalism.

By applying liberalism, it is possible to provide solutions for the South China Sea dispute. Liberalism posits that economic institutions play a crucial role in enhancing cooperation through the mechanism of economic interdependence. A joint development agreement can be a solution.

In this way, it is recommended to the involved countries to reach a common discourse about the exploitation of common resources by leaving aside the problems related to governance. One of the main liberal features is economic interdependence. Joint agreements for the exploration and extraction of oil and gas for the equitable collective use of resources is a liberal solution. The agreement between China and Vietnam on the joint exploration and development of the Gulf of Tonkin is a good example of how the mutual economic interests founded by liberalism can cause territorial disputes to be ignored. In fact, the real motivation behind the claim that it is a territorial issue has been identified by liberalism as common interests and solved it well.

Another basic solution that can be designed and implemented based on the principles of liberalism is the discovery, strengthening, and expansion of common regional norms among the countries involved. During this method, cooperation and collective security are highlighted and unilateral actions are avoided. This method causes long-term stability and mutual trust. The ASEAN Code of Conduct in the South China Sea is one of the measures being implemented in this direction. One of its important principles is to refrain from militarization by the parties to the conflict. Establishing and institutionalizing trust-building measures such as joint maneuvers will demilitarize the China Sea and create collective security and long-term peace.

One of the basic principles of liberalism is the power of international law. Referral of disputes with an international institution leads to reaching an impartial solution that is trusted and accepted by the parties. Institutional arbitration has the potential to help resolve the South China Sea dispute. Having said that, as mentioned earlier, China has obstructed the process of using institutional arbitration and has not accepted the ruling. This can cause conflicts and tensions increase. The asymmetry of power between the countries involved has made it difficult to reach a consensus on a mutual solution. In cases like China's behavior towards the court ruling, international pressure

through diplomacy and negotiation is a liberal solution. Because countries including China prevent damage to its reputation to avoid economic isolation. Perhaps an independent regional legal counsel for mediation would be a valuable solution. Another long-term solution is to create forums for cultural and educational exchanges with a focus on common understanding and creating common norms. The South China Sea Peace and Development Forum is one of these measures to protect the environment and humanitarian challenges.

In a context based on liberalism, the South China Sea dispute will be best resolved if multilateral cooperation replaces unilateral claims of superiority and territoriality. In this case, the South China Sea will become a model of international cooperation.

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Section 4: Synthesis and Reflection (10%)

Question: "How do Waltz's structural realism and Reus-Smit's Constructivism differ on anarchy? Provide specific references from the readings to support your answer."

Reus-Smit tries to first give a detailed explanation of the concept of anarchy according to Kenneth Waltz. Waltz's assumptions that the international system is anarchic and survival as the first goals of states leads him to a solution called military power. Meanwhile, they use the international system instead of the international community term. This shows that the traditional assumptions used by neorealists, such as anarchic conditions, are considered objective and immutable assumptions. Perhaps one of the most important reasons should be considered in the duration and age of these assumptions. This means that they have a long life as if they have existed since eternity and the idea of change in them is beyond imagination. In fact, we take them for granted. The suggestion of constructivists for the possibility of changing these meanings is rooted in factors that realists have not considered in their set of assumptions. Concepts are created by society. That is, immaterial factors also play a role in their formation. For example, the functions of a society can be changed or destroyed during the process of social, identity and normative changes of society. Many of the behaviors that the newer generations do compared to the previous ones had completely

different meanings in the past. It could be perceived as disrespectful, disobedient, or acting against the norm. The dynamics of societies have led to continuous redefining of the concepts they use. The concept of anarchy is also changeable when measured by non-material factors and does not always lead to a specific result because it is not only material in nature. Therefore, critiquing the concepts of power structures from this point of view can lead to the possibility of imagining alternatives because, according to constructivists, material structures gain social significance only through shared intersubjective semantic structures. The important point is that the meanings that define the concepts are the result of a time-consuming and sometimes experimental process. To change the definition of the concept of anarchy, one cannot rely only on the interest in change by creating transformed or new norms and identities. Changes on this basis take time and require practical participation. In fact, what constructivism suggests is not a simple and quick task. What is certain is the importance of the concept of anarchy in international relations. Because it provides the foundation stone for many assumptions and subsequent reactions.

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- Burchill, S., Paterson, M., Reus-Smit, C., Linklater, A., Devetak, R., True, J., & Donnelly, J. (2005). *Theories of International Relations, Third Edition*. Palgrave Macmillan. <https://books.google.com.cy/books?id=QzGhAQAACAAJ>
- Griffiths, M. (2007). *International Relations Theory for the Twenty-First Century: An Introduction*. Taylor & Francis. https://books.google.com.cy/books?id=TKZ_AgAAQBAJ